

WISHFUL DAYDREAMS

Greetings, my dearest friends. God bless each one of you. Blessed is this hour.

Each step forward on this path brings you closer to a powerful eternal current in the universe. You may call it the life force, or you may call it an aspect of God, or you may call it pure reason, pure love, pure being. Each little victory may occasionally give you a glimpse of this great freedom, of this indescribable happiness.

Mankind is so separated from this current due to all his obstructions -- in short, through his selfishness, egocentricity, fearfulness, cowardice. But every time a particle of these obstructions is eliminated, removed perhaps only by some recognition, your experience of a sense of freedom, of renewal, and of meaningfulness is increased.

The way we see man is that he barricades himself behind a wall of separateness. This wall is a useless and illusory form of self-protection. In the last analysis, this so-called self-protection is but the protection against happiness, against freedom. So, my friends, realize for all time that the goal of this work of dissolving your obstructions is to enable you to get into this great flow. The ultimate reason for living is to make a meaningful experience out of it, and without being merged into this current, such meaningful experience cannot be.

Many people feel that life is meaningless, whether or not such thoughts are conscious. Apart from the successful execution of this work of self-finding, there is also another approach as an additional way to arrive at the point in which life takes on new meaning. This is a simple bit of advice. Question yourself as to the direction of your activities in regard to exclusive self-satisfaction or, regarding the purpose of doing what you do, of wanting what you want, whether it is for the sake of other people or for the good of the activity itself. If you wish to find meaning in your life, cultivate this thought: "I would do something that is beneficial not only for my shortsighted immediate goal, but something that brings meaning to others, be it help, be it happiness, be it whatever else is truly constructive and productive." If such thoughts are sincerely meant, what better prayer could there be? What prayer of this sort would not be answered?

Often the inner person has cultivated such a desire without even being consciously aware of it. Then things begin to happen. In other instances, the inner person resists leaving the wall of separateness, while outer good will may exist in a sort of lukewarm way. Then nothing happens. Life continues to be meaningless. Living is constantly postponed in such cases. When this is the case, realize that, somewhere within, you are unwilling to leave your isolation and your inner isolationism. You are too fearful and selfish, too self-concerned in a negative way to break down the barriers so as to bring meaning to yourself and others, to be able to experience fully.

This slightly new approach may be important for many of my friends. It may be a more direct way of dealing with some of your immediate life problems. If you cannot progress and gain sufficient new insights to relieve you from dullness and meaninglessness of your existence, try this approach, as well as your ordinary way of working and searching within. If at first you can but verify your disinclination to give out, and where you do, at best, you only do so dutifully, awareness of this fact will in itself bring about change in you and prepare you for the inner readiness to give up inner isolationism.

And now, my friends, I would like to discuss a new topic. Let us discuss wishful daydreaming. Let us understand their origin, their harm, and their benefit. For there is also a benefit, although often a precarious one.

Basically, there are two different kinds of wishful daydreams. One kind comes from thoughts, and the thoughts come from drives. These drives are connected with your idealized self-image, your self-glorification, inadequacy, your lack of self-confidence. There is no human being who does not, even consciously at times, indulge in daydreams. In them, he sees himself in situations in which he proves to those who have slighted him his superiority, his greatness. In such daydreams, now they admire him instead. They convince themselves that they were mistaken about him, and he experiences satisfaction, revenge, gratified pride. Thus he enjoys living in a way that is the very opposite of his deep-rooted feelings of inadequacy and inferiority. He corrects his undesirable reality by fantasies, as it were.

The harm lies in the fact that precious energy is being spent on fabricating such wishful daydreams, energy that could be spent in the much more constructive pursuit of finding the root of the inadequacy and eliminating it. In living such fantasies, a certain momentary relief is experienced, but it is a relief that is purely illusory. It is not enough to say that daydreaming is escaping reality. This is true, but let us understand more precisely in what way this happens. If you resist finding the truth about yourself -- the truth of your errors and misconceptions -- you cannot come to terms with yourself, with others, and with life as a whole, or at least in all those aspects that are affected by your problems. So you whisk these inadequacies away by experiencing the opposite in fantasies. It is true that this brings relief in a drab life, but the fact that this relief is available will hamper your efforts at finding cause and effect, in removing cause and effect, and in instituting more constructive patterns.

However, there is also a benefit to this mechanism. One benefit is that, out of the fact that the realistic remedy is not sought, through the activity of correcting life in fantasy, aggression and hostility and destructive impulses are removed. Another beneficial factor is that these daydreams are a symptom. How can you ever find a sickness if there is no symptom? If a physical disease is hidden in the inner organ without its producing a symptom, it would deny you the opportunity of seeking and treating the origin before it is too late. The same mechanism exists when it comes to your soul life.

However, most people enjoy the symptom, and do not wish to recognize it for what it is, and therefore do not benefit from the symptom. Again I say, to simply repress, by some form of discipline, your desire for producing daydreams will not serve any purpose. It will create greater anxiety and different outlets and symptoms. It is better to pick up a little detached distance from this activity of producing corrections in your life by daydreaming fantasies. Observe their particular

pattern. Keep a note of them. Realize their general characteristics, their common denominator, their underlying goal. This will offer you invaluable material about the root of your problems. Instead of repressing daydreaming and instead of indulging in them without trying to observe and understand, make them the beneficial symptom that they are. Thus you will turn a destructive activity into a constructive one as long as this activity is a necessity for you. But your psyche will give it up to the degree that you learn to live life in reality. Then they will simply cease by themselves. This cessation must be a natural, organic process, but before this comes about, you must learn to observe and evaluate them.

The second category of wishful daydreaming is emotional in nature and comes from needs, as opposed to those from drives. We have gone into the subject of needs quite extensively. Your repressed, unrecognized needs may create an even stronger force just because they are repressed. This force must have an outlet, which then occurs often through this other kind of daydreaming. If the healthy pursuit of need fulfillment is hindered through your pseudosolutions, unrealistic fears, erroneous images that paralyze your constructive energy and resourcefulness, then an imaginary outlet is necessary. Physical, emotional, mental, and spiritual fulfillment is then possible only in fantasies. Again, this is a relief, and again, it is not enough to say that it is merely escape from drab reality.

When you are unwilling to leave your isolation, your needs cannot be fulfilled. As you know from previous talks on the subject, you then either repress awareness of these needs, or you displace them into indirect, superimposed needs that are not your genuine ones. All this creates confusion, knots, paralysis of your spontaneity, of your capacity to feel, to live, to experience in reality. This in turn creates many vicious circles which then make it even more difficult to come out of this destructive pattern. Since your psyche refuses to let you cheat it from living, the accumulated pressure often makes it necessary to provide some outlet. So you may experience a certain fulfillment in daydreams. Only by observing and evaluating your daydreams can you learn to what category they belong -- it is very likely that you produce both kinds -- and what unfulfilled real needs may be contained in them.

The more satisfying your fantasy fulfillment is, the less incentive will you have to resolve your problems so that fulfillment can become a reality. You live a life of your own behind your walls of isolation in which you can direct everything as you choose without interference from others, without outer obstructions. This seems more favorable. The more you live in these daydreams, the less will it be possible to deal with outer obstructions, and the greater will become their influence on you. It will finally seem to you that actual fulfillment is impossible because, in reality, you cannot direct as you choose. This, of course, is utterly untrue since fulfillment is possible in spite of the fact that not everything happens exactly how and when you desire it. But this is only possible if you are flexible and go with life's stream. In the unconscious conviction that fulfillment is impossible in reality, you completely withdraw from living and no longer try. The precarious pseudofulfillment is, at least, something and is so much more than, at this stage, you are capable of experiencing in reality. Determine if this holds true with you, and to what extent. This will be so beneficial, so health bringing!

Yet, to a degree, the existence of some daydreaming of this sort may even spur you on to seek fulfillment in reality. Then they do have a beneficial effect. It depends here on what level you produce them and what your attitude is to them.

The more immature a person is, the more "successful" will his daydreaming be and, therefore the less will he be capable of and willing to live his life now and in reality, and the more will he need complete control of circumstances to which he has access only in his daydreams. And conversely, the less will he be capable of experiencing fulfillment even while he is flexible and resilient to outer circumstances that are not entirely according to his plans and prescribed ideas. The discrepancy between his daydream situations in which he can make others behave, say, feel, react as he wants, and the reality situation which is often different and does need flexibility, patience, and a lack of childish obstinacy, is too much for him. Thus he prefers living in his dreams, in a would-be situation in which he deceives himself into believing that all that will occur in the future -- now he lives it in fantasy, tomorrow in reality. Of course, the morrow never comes. It goes on being deferred. Frustration is often caused by the fact that the reality situation never conforms to the fantasy situation that has been laboriously prepared in daydreaming. The latter seems so much more satisfying. But the former is infinitely more satisfying, provided courage and flexibility is adopted, provided one gives up the need to control everything, provided one gives up the blueprints and lives spontaneously.

The foregoing should make it quite clear wherein lies the harm of such daydreaming. It may prevent you from living in reality. Now, what is the benefit? Apart from the same benefit applying to the other type of daydreaming, namely the fact that it presents symptoms from which much insight can be gained, there are still further benefits. One, already mentioned, is that daydreams may spur on the incentive to live fully. Also, they can be thermometers and show up inner changes. The different quality of your emotional daydreaming, of the kind of satisfaction you derive in your fantasy, may indeed be an indication of your growth, of the direction in which you are moving onward. To determine this is very beneficial.

Moreover, the activity of daydreaming of this kind encourages your repressed needs to reach your awareness. You will appreciate by now how important this is. But it happens very often, my friends, that this conscious awareness of your needs exists in a way rather halfhearted. You are conscious, but without the evaluation of what it means. You allow your emotions to experience these needs only during the activity of your daydreaming. However, the moment you step into real life, you shut off this awareness, and you live as though this other part of you had nothing to do with the rest of your life. This fragmentizes you and causes a split that could be mended by an increasing awareness that is retained, evaluated, and with its significance understood. That then is the harm of daydreams, the failure to take advantage of the benefit they could be.

If you develop a greater awareness of all your daydreaming, you will derive much benefit. It is my advice to many of you who are on this path that whenever you find yourself engaged in this activity, develop a new approach. Observe, watch, evaluate, note, weigh, determine, but do so without strain, compulsion, or pressure, just calmly and quietly. Make daydreams the useful symptom which they are meant to be by learning from them about yourself, about your real needs, about your drives, about your pseudofulfillment in them, about their goal.

Now, are there any questions on this subject?

QUESTION: I have many daydreams. When I stop, my fears become active. When my fears recede, I start daydreaming again. Why is that?

ANSWER: Because, you see, my friend, both have the same common denominator, the same root. They both are an expression of your self-alienation. You know perfectly well from your recent findings that your conscious fears are not your real fears. They are displaced fears. They are the fears you want to have rather than the basic fear that you do not wish to face: the fear of being yourself. You are aware of this, are you not?

Therefore, since these are not your real fears, they take the same escape mechanism as your daydreams. You experience either substitute fears or substitute fulfillments. Since you do not face and tackle the problem of becoming yourself, you cannot have the fulfillment that everyone inwardly strives for. Therefore you create substitute fulfillments which you partially experience only in fantasy. It is just as though your psyche says, "So long as I do not face my real fear, I do not mind having other fears. But as long as I remain in this attitude, I cannot be fulfilled. Therefore I need substitute fulfillment." The one is tied to the other. This is why you alternate between experiencing pseudofears and pseudofulfillment in daydreams.

QUESTION: I can't connect my daydreams and my fears in a concrete way.

ANSWER: This is not necessary. If you proceed to face the reason why you fear to be yourself, and develop from that point, these other questions will fall into place. But if you wish, you can observe the nature of your daydreams and the nature of your fears, and you might discover the connection that I just indicated.

QUESTION: What is the difference between drives and needs?

ANSWER: A need is a very basic function of the human entity. A need is something real unless it is displaced and superimposed with an unreal one. A drive, as I mentioned earlier, comes from compulsions which, in turn, come into existence out of misconceptions, out of your images, your lack of belief in yourself, your idealized self-image, and from resorting to pseudosolutions. All these create drives, while the needs may be wants that are utterly healthy.

QUESTION: If a person does not daydream at all, is this a sign of lack of imagination or of maturity?

ANSWER: It could be a sign of maturity, but not always. It would again be a hasty and oversimplified generalization to answer this question with an either/or. If a person does not consciously daydream, it may also indicate something else, but not necessarily a lack of imagination. This is a label that would not get us very far. For what is lack of imagination? It may mean that your creative faculties are inhibited. Not having conscious daydreams may also indicate resignation, stagnation. This may sound paradoxical because I just finished telling you that an overproduction of daydreams at the expense of actual living is unhealthy. Now I am telling you not to daydream may also be unhealthy and a symptom of your unresolved problems. Nevertheless, this is often so in many respects. The presence of a symptom may indicate something quite similar to its absence. Overproduction of daydreaming at the expense of actual living may indicate that a part of the psyche is not at all reconciled to not living. Underproduction of them may indicate an inner giving up. But it depends very much on the kind of daydreaming, as well as on many other considerations, to accurately determine the reason.

The loss of conscious desires, wishes, and goals, or the hopelessness about them due to not daring to leave isolation and separateness may paralyze the life force so much that the person no longer strives in any direction, not even in fantasy. But there are many other factors, too, and it is quite impossible to give a pat answer.

QUESTION: Isn't it often the case that when one is younger one daydreams, but when one gets older and when one knows that these goals are not anymore reachable that one gives up daydreaming entirely?

ANSWER: Of course, it is possible. But it is also very often the case that these daydreams have not been given up. They merely take on a different form or manifestation.

QUESTION: I'm confused about harmony and happiness. I always thought they were the same. Also, it is said that the universal laws are harmonious, yet many manifestations of nature are not harmonious at all.

ANSWER: You see only fragments of these laws. If you see a fragment of a whole, then you cannot perceive the meaning -- and cannot therefore understand the harmony. In fact, by seeing only a fragment of the whole, it may even appear as the opposite of the whole, although it is absolutely true that, in a higher state of being, harmony and happiness are the same, just as love, truth, wisdom, as well as any other divine manifestations are all one whole. The lower the states of development, the more they appear as not being the same. On your earth sphere, all divine manifestations may or may not appear as being the same. For instance, a truth may hurt, at least temporarily. To the extent that the person develops, to that degree will the most unpleasant truth have a liberating effect and thus no longer be contradictory to love. The less the person is developed, the more does he experience unpleasant truth as harsh and unloving. Separateness of concepts exists where imperfection exists, where separateness of soul exists. The unifying of these concepts, when they all become one, comes as development, and with it, the awareness of reality grows. The more you are in reality, the more does your outlook grow, the more do the many little fragments make up a whole. This is then perceived in the individual as well as in the universe. Every universe in creation conforms to the average state of the entities inhabiting that particular universe or cosmic sphere. Therefore the harmony in the universal laws must sometimes dwell in their apparent hardship. Without this hardship, unification could not take place. This does not mean, my friends, that this is a punishment by an arbitrary God. It is inherent in the laws to work according to their environmental conditions. For example, an electric current will manifest differently in a wet environment than in a dry one. The potent forces of these universal laws are determined by the existing climate, so to speak, at any given moment. In other words, what you do with the laws, your attitude to them determines their manifestation; whether done consciously or unconsciously makes no difference. Thus they may at times have a benign effect, at other times a momentary hostile one. But even the latter is geared to establishing balance eventually.

QUESTION: Sometimes when we have an unsolved problem and we go to sleep relaxed, intending to have the problem resolved, it may happen that one wakes up with the solution. Then one's unconscious mind has solved it.

ANSWER: Terms are often confused by many people. And the terms are really not important as long as we understand what is meant. There is really only one thing important to know about the meaning of the unconscious, whatever name you give to it, and that is lack of awareness. When you are unconscious, you are not aware. Now, there are degrees, of course. Do not imagine that your unconscious mind is either a perfect or wise supercreature, or a monstrous animal. Many people have both extreme attitudes toward their unconscious. It is neither. The unconscious mind does not necessarily have anything to do with your real self, with the higher self, nor with the lower self, or that part in you which you negate. Both sides of your nature can be conscious in part and unconscious in part. As far as both sides are concerned, you may have different levels of awareness. For instance, you may be conscious of certain factors in yourself or about general concepts, but you are not conscious of the entire significance. Then awareness is neither completely absent, nor is it completely present. There exists, then, a degree of awareness.

The reason for being able to resolve certain problems during sleep, by instructing one's unconscious mind to do so, for instance, is due to the fact that knowledge exists in you of which you are not aware. In certain states of relaxation and concentration (for instance, concentrating on the will before going to sleep), this unconscious knowledge can reach surface awareness. Your entire striving on this earth sphere is to increase your own awareness of what is already stored in you. In such a state of relaxation, it is also possible for spirit helpers to aid in bringing your own knowledge to the surface. In other words, it is a combination of the spirit world working with your own real self. What is necessary for such awareness -- and it does not matter to what degree spirits help your own real self to come to the surface -- is the constructive functioning of your own inner will. Therefore a person who goes to sleep and faces, let us say, a confusion, a problem, and wholeheartedly desires to resolve it in the best possible way even if this means parting from a selfish aim, then he creates a state of inner openness where these productive universal forces of truth and constructiveness can get to work. But when the confusion is not tackled, when one is not fully aware of what the confusion is and in exactly what way, such answers cannot come. Hence, a conscious effort has to be made most of the time. Sometimes, of course, as I said before, it happens that an unconscious desire exists of which the person is unaware.

I give you blessings, each and every one of you. May you derive benefit from these words, may they help you to a new approach to your problems, to yourselves, to life, to your life experience. Be blessed, every one of you. Blessed are your wonderful efforts. Rejoice in the knowledge that whatever you do in life, every step of finding yourself in sincerity has great meaning even if you are as yet unaware of the effect it must have, not only upon yourself but upon many others, upon your universe at large. Be in peace, be in God!

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